Language Usage practice booklet: Grade 10 expectations

Grade 10 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Language Usage at Grade 10 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

Standards practised: L.9-10.2, L.9-10.2a, L.9-10.2b, L.9-10.2c

A worked example

Punctuate it: The souq opens at nine however Maryam arrived at eight

1. There are two complete sentences: The souq opens at nine and Maryam arrived at eight.
2. However is a conjunctive adverb joining them, so a semicolon goes before it and a comma after it.
3. Finish with a full stop.

The souq opens at nine; however, Maryam arrived at eight.

Questions

1. Punctuate it: The metro was delayed this morning however Hamdan still reached school on time.

---

2. Join the two sentences with a semicolon and no other word: Layla loves astronomy. Her brother prefers robotics.

---

3. Add the colon: Salem packed three items for the desert trip a water bottle, a hat, and sunscreen.

---

4. Which sentence is punctuated correctly? (a) The recipe calls for: dates, flour, and butter. (b) The recipe calls for dates, flour, and butter.

---

5. A complete sentence introduces the quotation, so add a colon: Noura read the sign aloud "Please keep the beach clean."

---

6. Explain why the comma is wrong in this sentence, and give one way to fix it: The creek was calm, the boats rocked gently.

---

7. Choose the right word: The committee will (accept / except) the award on behalf of the school.

---

8. Choose the right word: The new dhow is faster (than / then) the old ferry.

---

9. Choose the right word: The school (principal / principle) welcomed the visitors at the gate.

---

10. Choose the right word: Omar and Khalid left (their / there / they're) bags at the gate.

---

11. Which spelling is correct: occurence, occurrence or occurance?

---

12. Correct the apostrophe: The childrens books were left on the metro.

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

Standards practised: L.9-10.1, L.9-10.1a, L.9-10.1b, L.9-10.3

A worked example

Make the list parallel: Salem likes hiking, to swim, and riding camels.

1. The list has three activities, so each should have the same form.
2. Hiking and riding camels are -ing forms; to swim is not.
3. Change to swim into swimming.

Salem likes hiking, swimming, and riding camels.

Questions

1. Make the list parallel using -ing forms: Hind enjoys reading, painting, and to play chess.

---

2. Name the appositive: Maryam, a marine biologist, studies the mangroves.

---

3. Name the dependent clause and say what kind it is: Because the road flooded, the bus was late.

---

4. Combine the sentences with a relative clause: The Hope Probe reached Mars. It was launched from Japan.

---

5. Name the mood of the verb: If the metro were free, more people would ride it.

---

6. Choose the right verb: The teacher suggested that Khalid (study / studies) the map tonight.

---

7. Change to the active voice: The report was written by Noura and Hind.

---

8. Combine these short sentences into one varied sentence: The market opened. It was busy. People bought spices.

---

9. Choose the right verb: The collection of old dates (is / are) on the table.

---

10. Correct the tense shift in this story, which is told in the past tense: Hamdan opened the door and sees the falcon.

---

11. Choose the right word: The woman to (who / whom) Noura gave the map was a teacher.

---

12. Explain what is wrong with this sentence and rewrite it: Running to catch the metro, Hind's bag fell open.

Section 3: Writing

Standards practised: W.9-10.1, W.9-10.1a, W.9-10.1b, W.9-10.2, W.9-10.2a, W.9-10.3, W.9-10.3a, W.9-10.5

A worked example

Plan an argument paragraph: should schools in the UAE offer a coding class to every student? Write a claim, two reasons and a counterclaim with a response.

1. Claim: Every school in the UAE should offer a coding class.
2. Reason 1: coding builds problem-solving skills that help in many subjects.
3. Reason 2: many future jobs will use digital skills.
4. Counterclaim: the timetable is already full. Response: a short weekly lesson can replace time spent on repeated practice.

Claim: Every school should offer coding. Reasons: it builds problem-solving skills, and many future jobs use digital skills. Counterclaim: the timetable is full. Response: a short weekly lesson can replace repeated practice.

Questions

1. Which sentence is a claim that can be argued? (a) The Dubai Metro opened in 2009. (b) Cities in the UAE should build more cycling lanes.

2. Make this claim more precise: Solar parks are good.

3. Write a counterclaim and a response for this claim: School should start an hour later.

4. Plan it: you will argue that your neighbourhood should use the metro more than cars. List a claim, two reasons with evidence, and a counterclaim with a response.

5. Choose the best transition to add a second reason: The metro is cheaper than driving. ____, it avoids traffic. (However / In addition / Therefore)

---

6. Revise in a formal style: Kids these days spend way too much time on their phones, which is kind of a big deal.

---

7. Revise to remove wordiness: In my personal opinion, I believe that the library should be open in the evenings as well.

---

8. Write an introductory sentence for an informative essay about how desalination provides drinking water in the UAE.

---

9. Which detail best supports the topic sentence Falcons are skilled hunters? (a) Falcons are often seen at desert camps. (b) A falcon can spot small prey from far away and dive at great speed. (c) Many families care for falcons.

---

10. Revise this sentence with sensory details instead of naming the feeling: The evening was peaceful.

---

11. Plan a narrative. Fill in a planner with a narrator, a setting, a conflict, the main events in order, and a resolution. Use this start: Noura and her cousin Maryam find a locked box on the beach.

---

12. Put these sentences in the best order: (a) Next, volunteers dig holes along the shore. (b) First, the class chooses a site for the mangrove seedlings. (c) Finally, they water each seedling.

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Capital letters, punctuation and spelling

1. The metro was delayed this morning; however, Hamdan still reached school on time. (a semicolon before the conjunctive adverb, a comma after it)
2. Layla loves astronomy; her brother prefers robotics. (a semicolon joins two closely related complete sentences)
3. Salem packed three items for the desert trip: a water bottle, a hat, and sunscreen. (a colon follows a complete sentence that introduces a list)
4. (b). A colon should not come straight after a verb such as calls for; it follows a complete sentence.
5. Noura read the sign aloud: "Please keep the beach clean." (a colon after a complete sentence introduces the quotation)
6. Two complete sentences are joined only by a comma (a comma splice). Fixes: use a semicolon (The creek was calm; the boats rocked gently), a full stop, or a comma with a joining word such as and.
7. accept (a verb meaning to receive; except means to leave out)
8. than (used in comparisons; then refers to time)
9. principal (the head of a school; a principle is a rule or belief)
10. their (it shows that the bags belong to them)
11. occurrence (two c's and two r's)
12. The children's books were left on the metro. (children is already plural, so the possessive adds 's)

Section 2: Grammar and word usage

1. Hind enjoys reading, painting, and playing chess. (all three items have the same form)
2. a marine biologist (a noun phrase that renames Maryam)
3. Because the road flooded; an adverbial clause (it tells why the bus was late and cannot stand alone as a sentence)
4. Model answer: The Hope Probe, which was launched from Japan, reached Mars. (any correct sentence that turns the second sentence into a who or which clause is fine)
5. Subjunctive (were is used for a situation that is imagined or contrary to fact)
6. study (after a verb of suggestion or request, the subjunctive uses the base form)
7. Noura and Hind wrote the report. (the doer of the action becomes the subject)
8. Model answer: When the market opened, it was busy with people buying spices. (any smooth, correct sentence that keeps all three ideas is fine)
9. is (the subject is collection, which is singular; of old dates is a phrase that does not change it)
10. Hamdan opened the door and saw the falcon. (both verbs stay in the past tense)
11. whom (it is the object of the preposition to; test it: Noura gave the map to her)
12. The opening phrase seems to describe the bag, but it was Hind who was running (a dangling modifier). Model: Running to catch the metro, Hind felt her bag fall open. or As Hind ran to catch the metro, her bag fell open.

Section 3: Writing

1. (b). It states a position that people could agree or disagree with. (a) is a fact.
2. A good answer names who or what and gives a specific position. Model: Solar parks should supply more of the UAE's electricity because they cut pollution and use a resource the country has in abundance.
3. A good answer states a fair opposing view and answers it with a reason. Model: Some people say a later start means a later finish to the day. However, students who sleep longer concentrate better, so the later finish is worth it.
4. A good answer has a clear claim, two different reasons each backed by a fact or example (for example, the metro avoids traffic and costs less than fuel and parking), and a fair counterclaim (stations may be far from home) with a response (feeder buses and walking routes connect to stations). Answers will vary.
5. In addition (it adds one more reason; However shows contrast and Therefore shows a result)
6. Model: Young people spend a great deal of time on their phones, which is a serious concern. (a good answer removes slang and vague phrases)
7. Model: The library should be open in the evenings. (or: I believe the library should be open in the evenings.) The meaning is kept in fewer words.
8. A good answer names the topic and prepares the reader for what follows. Model: Desalination plants along the UAE coast remove salt from seawater to provide much of the country's drinking water.
9. (b). It gives a fact that shows why falcons hunt well. (a) and (c) are about where falcons are seen or who keeps them.
10. A good answer uses sights, sounds or actions. Model: A soft breeze moved the palm leaves, and the sky over the creek turned the colour of ripe apricots.
11. A good plan names who tells the story, a clear setting, a conflict (for example, the girls must find the owner or the key), three or more events in order, and a resolution that solves the conflict. Answers will vary.
12. b, a, c. (the transitions First, Next and Finally show the order of the steps)